SCENE 006 — OPEN WROUGHTWOOD

Trigger: Day 3 morning — town fully opens **Time:** Day 3 through end of game **Location:** Wroughtwood — full town map **Incoming Flags:** All prior flags, INN_ESTABLISHED, DARNELL_THREE_DAY_TIMER

DAYS 1 & 2 — RESTRICTED PHASE

> *Marcus does not have free movement until Day 3. The first two days are structured and linear — he is new, watched, and on thin ice.*

Day 1 covers Scenes 001–005. Marcus arrives, meets Pruitt, gets a room, meets Hattie. Movement is limited to the inn and immediate main road. The town is observing him.

Day 2 opens the inn job board and allows Marcus to move along the main road and visit the church and feed store — but only in direct service of jobs or errands. Ambient NPC interactions begin. Calhoun's first encounter triggers if Marcus passes the feed store. Cade can be met at the church if the fence job is taken. Town is still sizing Marcus up.

The restriction lifts on Day 3 morning — the same morning Darnell's call comes in that evening. The world opens exactly when the pressure does.

STRUCTURE OVERVIEW

Scene 006 is not a single scene — it is the **open world framework** of Damned Moon. From Day 3 onward the player moves through Wroughtwood freely, managing stats, pursuing story threads, and navigating NPC relationships across a day/night cycle.

DAY / NIGHT CYCLE

Phase	Time	What It Means
Morning	6am–12pm	Town open, most NPCs available, jobs posted
Afternoon	12pm–6pm	Full access, best window for rapport building
Evening	6pm–10pm	Town thins out, some NPCs retreat indoors, Hattie's front desk gossip window opens
Night	10pm–6am	**Danger phase.** HUNGER climbs faster. RAGE climbs if HUNGER > 60. Certain locations unlock. The pack moves.

> *Each in-game day Marcus must manage HUNGER or face a RAGE cascade. By Day 3 HUNGER climbs to 60 overnight without intervention. By Day 5 it climbs to 80. Marie is the only character who can teach Marcus to manage it sustainably.*

TOWN MAP — Locations

Location	Available	Key NPC	Function
Hattie's Inn	Always	Hattie	Rest, jobs, gossip, Darnell's call Day 3
Calhoun's Feed Store	Daytime	Aldous Calhoun	Jobs, RAGE pressure, town power
Sheriff's Office	Daytime	Ray Pruitt	Report trouble, check in, story flags
Wroughtwood Church	Morning/Evening	Reverend Elias Cade	Humanity recovery, crisis of faith thread
The Mill	Daytime	Foreman (unnamed)	Labour jobs, proximity to swamp path
Main Road	Always	Various townspeople	Ambient interactions, reputation visible
North Road	Daytime only	—	Car retrieval window, pack territory at night
Swamp Path	Day or Night	—	Path to Marie — night is faster but dangerous
Marie's Swamp	Unlocks via TRUST_MARIE progress	Marie Veau	Lore, hunger management, housing option

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ALDOUS CALHOUN

Location: Calhoun's Feed Store **Role:** Town power broker, primary RAGE antagonist

Who He Is

Aldous Calhoun is perhaps sixty, built like a man who worked hard once and has spent twenty years reminding people of it. He owns the feed store, the mill, and a significant portion of Wroughtwood's opinion. His family has been here nearly as long as the Pruitts. He considers himself the town's memory and its standard.

He is a racist. Not the theatrical kind — the casual, structural kind that has never once needed to raise its voice because the whole town is already arranged to agree with it. He sees Marcus and makes a decision in the first two seconds that no subsequent behavior will fully reverse.

He will not touch Marcus. He is not stupid. But he will work at him — small cuts, consistent, patient — every single time their paths cross.

Calhoun Encounters — Repeating RAGE Pressure Events

> *These trigger whenever Marcus enters Calhoun's space or takes a job nearby. They escalate subtly over the course of the game.*

ENCOUNTER C1 — First Meeting Calhoun is behind the counter when Marcus enters. He doesn't look up immediately. Makes Marcus wait. When he does look up his expression is the particular blankness of a man who has decided the thing in front of him doesn't require much adjustment to his face.

"Help you with something?" The tone says the opposite.

Player Choices:

- **State your business plainly** → COMPOSURE maintains, Calhoun gives minimal service, Marcus gets what he came for
- **Match his energy** → RAGE +10, Calhoun smiles like he won something, CALHOUN_PROVOKED_1 set
- **Say nothing, conduct business, leave** → COMPOSURE +1, HUMANITY +5 — *the discipline of that silence costs more than it looks like*
- **[RAGE > 50 check]** → A fourth option appears: *"Make him understand."* Selecting it triggers a RAGE spike event and CALHOUN_INCIDENT_1 — Calhoun files a complaint with Pruitt. PRUITT_REL degrades one level.

ENCOUNTER C2 — The Comment *(Day 2+)* Calhoun is on his porch when Marcus passes. Loud enough for the two men with him to hear:

"Hear that stranger's staying at Hattie's place. Surprised she's got room — thought she had standards."

Laughter. Comfortable laughter. The kind that's been laughing at the same things its whole life.

Player Choices:

- **Keep walking** → RAGE +10, HUMANITY +5 — *Marcus keeps walking. Something in his jaw tightens. He keeps walking.*
- **Stop and look at him** → RAGE +15, CALHOUN_UNSETTLED_1 — Calhoun holds the stare but one of the men with him shifts in his chair
- **[RAGE > 60 check]** → *"Say it again."* — Marcus stops moving entirely. His voice is flat in a way that isn't quite human. Calhoun goes quiet. For one moment something in his expression is not contempt. It's something older. PRUITT_NOTIFIED_INCIDENT triggered — Pruitt hears about it by evening.

ENCOUNTER C3 — The Accusation *(Day 4+, if TEENS_HAVE_PACKAGE)* Calhoun finds his moment. One of the teens — the nervous one — told someone who told someone. Now Calhoun is at Hattie's door when Marcus comes down for breakfast.

"Understand you've been bothering some of the young people around here. About something they found."

He lets that sit. Watching Marcus's face.

"Sheriff might want to hear about that."

Player Choices:

- **Deny it** → Calhoun smiles. He doesn't believe it. It doesn't matter.
- **Acknowledge it and explain** → Calhoun cuts him off. He doesn't want the explanation. He wants the reaction.
- **Say nothing and look at Hattie** → Hattie steps forward. *"Aldous. I think that's enough for this morning."* HATTIE_DEFENDED_MARCUS set — costs Hattie social capital. She pays it without blinking.
- **[HUMANITY < 50 check]** → A dark option appears: *"Give him a reason."* Selecting this triggers a major RAGE event. The game does not let Marcus hurt Calhoun — but it lets him come close enough that Calhoun backs up. The whole town sees it. TOWN_FEARS_MARCUS set. Consequences cascade.

ENCOUNTER C4 — The Breaking Point *(Late game, automatic)*

> *Regardless of prior encounters, this scene triggers once DARNELL_IN_TOWN is set. Calhoun has connected Marcus to whatever Darnell represents and has decided Marcus is the source of Wroughtwood's trouble.*

Calhoun speaks to Pruitt publicly. On the main road. Loud enough for everyone to hear.

"This town has a way of handling problems that don't belong here."

He doesn't look at Marcus when he says it. He doesn't have to.

This is the scene that forces a choice — Marcus can no longer manage Calhoun with composure alone. The player must decide: use the wolf, use allies, or absorb the cost. Every prior decision about RAGE, HUMANITY, PRUITT_REL, and HATTIE_DEFENDED_MARCUS feeds into what options are available.

REVEREND ELIAS CADE

Location: Wroughtwood Church **Role:** Humanity recovery NPC, crisis of faith thread, potential lore source

Who He Is

Reverend Elias Cade is somewhere in his fifties — a tall man gone slightly soft, with the remnants of a commanding bearing that hasn't fully surrendered yet. He has a preacher's voice, deep and measured, that sounds like it was built for certainty. The certainty left some time ago. The voice stayed.

He drinks. Not obviously, not publicly — but the flask is never far and his breath in the afternoon tells the story his sermons don't. His church is attended out of habit by people who stopped listening and by Cade himself who stopped believing, somewhere between last winter and the one before it.

He is not a bad man. He is a man who looked at the thing underneath Wroughtwood and found that God did not seem to have an opinion about it, and that absence broke something structural in him.

He does not know what to do with Marcus. But he finds, to his own surprise, that he doesn't want him to leave.

Cade Encounters

ENCOUNTER E1 — First Meeting *(Church fence job or Marcus enters church)*

Cade is in a pew when Marcus finds him. Not praying. Just sitting, the way a man sits in an empty room he isn't sure is his anymore. He looks up when Marcus enters and there is no hostility in it — just the mild surprise of a man whose church doesn't get many visitors who aren't already locals.

He takes in Marcus's state without comment.

"You look like a man who's had a theological experience," he says, which is either a joke or the most accurate thing anyone in Wroughtwood has said to Marcus yet.

Player Choices:

- **Sit down** → Cade makes room without being asked. HUMANITY +5. The conversation begins.
- **State the job and keep it professional** → Cade lets it be. But watches Marcus work. By the time the fence is fixed he's standing in the yard with two cups of coffee and Marcus has a choice again.
- **Ask him about the town** → His eyes move to the window. *"Wroughtwood is a town that keeps its own counsel,"* he says slowly. *"Always has."* A pause. *"I've been here twenty years and some days I think I still don't know half of it."*

ENCOUNTER E2 — The Drink *(Afternoon visit, Day 2+)*

Cade is in the church office. The flask is on the desk between them, not hidden.

He looks at it. Looks at Marcus.

"I know what you're thinking," he says.

"I doubt it," Marcus says, or doesn't say.

"A man of God ought to be stronger than his troubles." He picks up the flask. *"That's what they teach you. That faith is the thing that holds when everything else lets go."* He drinks. *"I've been waiting for it to hold for about two years now."*

He looks at Marcus directly.

"What are you running from, son? Or is it running after you?"

Player Choices:

- **Tell him something true** → HUMANITY +10, TRUST unlocks deeper Cade conversations. He doesn't flinch at what Marcus tells him. He has been waiting for something that makes his doubts make sense.
- **Deflect with a question of your own** → Cade smiles tiredly. *"Fair enough."* He pours a second cup. They sit in the particular silence of two men who aren't ready yet.
- **Ask what broke his faith** → Long pause. *"I saw something in those woods two years ago."* He doesn't say what. He won't. Not yet. CADE_SAW_SOMETHING set — major lore flag for later.

ENCOUNTER E3 — The Confession *(Unlocked via CADE_SAW_SOMETHING + 2 subsequent visits)*

Cade tells Marcus what he saw.

Two years ago. A man from the next county over passed through Wroughtwood. Stayed three days. On the third night Cade heard something from the direction of the north road. He went to look.

He does not describe in detail what he saw. He describes the sound of it. The size of it against the tree line. The way it moved.

And then — quieter — the way it stopped moving when it noticed him. The way it looked at him. The intelligence in that look.

"It wasn't an animal," he says. *"Or it wasn't only an animal. There was a man in there somewhere looking out."* He drinks. *"I have spent two years trying to find a scripture that accounts for that. I haven't found one."*

He looks at Marcus.

"You know what I'm talking about, don't you."

[Not a question.] Player Choices:

- **Confirm it** → HUMANITY +15. Cade doesn't run. He sits very still and then nods slowly like something in him has been waiting for the permission of a witness. CADE_KNOWS set — Cade becomes a limited ally. Won't act against Marcus. May act for him at a critical moment.
- **Deny it** → HUMANITY -10. Cade looks at him for a long time. *"Alright,"* he says. He doesn't believe the denial. The flask goes back in the pocket. *"Be careful, Marcus."*

Cade's Church — HUMANITY Recovery Mechanic

> *Sitting in the church pew for one time unit restores HUMANITY +5 regardless of conversation. Available once per day. No explanation given — some places just hold something.*
> *If CADE_KNOWS is set, sitting in the church while Cade is present restores HUMANITY +10 instead.*

NIGHT CYCLE — What Moves in the Dark

> *Once the day/night cycle begins, nights are not safe or empty.*

HUNGER > 60 at nightfall → RAGE begins climbing +5 per night hour. Marcus cannot fully sleep. He lies in Hattie's inn listening to something he can't name.

HUNGER > 80 at nightfall → RAGE climbs +10 per hour. Marcus gets out of bed. The player must navigate him back to sleep or manage the hunger — or the blackout scene triggers.

BLACKOUT EVENT *(RAGE hits 100)* Screen goes dark. Text only:

You don't remember leaving the room. You don't remember the stairs or the road or the tree line. You remember a sound like the world cracking open. Then the field again. The cold again. The sky going gray again. Something happened. The town will know something happened. You don't know what.

Stat Reset: RAGE → 10, HUNGER → 10, HEALTH → 95 **Consequences:** A flag is set based on what night it is and what thread is active — the blackout always advances something Marcus didn't choose to advance. Sometimes it's evidence. Sometimes it's a body. Sometimes it's a door left open at Calhoun's store. The player has to manage the morning.

REPUTATION SYSTEM — How Wroughtwood Sees Marcus

> *Wroughtwood's opinion of Marcus is tracked as a hidden* `TOWN_REP` *score. It affects ambient NPC dialogue, job availability, and how much rope Pruitt gives him.*

Event	TOWN_REP Change
Completes inn job without incident	+5
Calhoun incident (any level)	-10
Hattie defends Marcus publicly	+5
Pruitt speaks well of Marcus	+10
Blackout event — evidence found in town	-20
Cade seen talking to Marcus publicly	+5
`TEENS_RAPPORT` built successfully	+10
Strength path used on teens	-15
Darnell arrives in town	-10 (guilt by association)

SCENE NOTES

- **Calhoun is not a boss.** He is a tax. Every encounter costs RAGE and the player must decide how much humanity to spend on self-control and how much to let the wolf handle it. The wolf's way is faster. It always is.
- **Cade saw something two years ago** — the man from the next county was the previous infected. That person's story is a thread worth pulling. What happened to them? Did they get out? Did the town handle it? Harlan would know.
- **The church as HUMANITY recovery** is subtle but important. Marcus isn't religious necessarily — but the building holds something. Given the land's history, that something might not be what Cade thinks it is.
- **Blackout consequences advancing plot** means RAGE 100 isn't just a failure state — it's a chaotic story engine. The player loses control but the story doesn't stop. It just goes somewhere Marcus didn't choose.

FLAGS SET / MODIFIED

Flag	Condition
CALHOUN_PROVOKED_1/2/3	Calhoun encounters, reactive choices
CALHOUN_INCIDENT_1	RAGE choice in C1
CALHOUN_UNSETTLED_1	Eye contact choice in C2
TOWN_FEARS_MARCUS	Humanity < 50 choice in C3
HATTIE_DEFENDED_MARCUS	C3, Hattie steps in
CADE_MET	Any church visit
CADE_SAW_SOMETHING	E2, asks what broke his faith
CADE_KNOWS	E3, Marcus confirms the truth
BLACKOUT_EVENT_1/2/3	RAGE hits 100, increments each time
TOWN_REP	Running score, modified throughout

LEADS TO — Active Threads from Scene 006

Thread	Trigger
Car Retrieval / Teen Quest	Player visits north road before Day 3 window closes
Marie Introduction	MILL_AREA_KNOWN set + TRUST_MARIE > 0 + player moves toward swamp
Darnell Arrives	Day 6 if DARNELL_THREE_DAY_TIMER not resolved
Curtis Sighting	Random night event after Day 4 — someone saw something in the woods. Description matches Curtis.
Harlan Returns	Day 5 — Harlan appears at the field edge at dawn again. Waits to see if Marcus comes.
CONTAINED Thread	Interacting with Harlan twice + DOMINION_THREAD flag set